Antonio Villani

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Education

PhD Candidate in Economics, Universitat Pompeu Fabra 2022–2027 (expected)
Advisors: Priit Jeenas and Jordi Galí

Master of Research in Economics (2nd year, PhD track), Universitat Pompeu Fabra 2021–2022

MSc in Economics and Finance (1st year, PhD track), Barcelona School of Economics 2020–2021

BA(Econ)(Hons) Economics and Philosophy, The University of Manchester 2017–2020
First Class Honours.
Thesis: "A defence of Salmon's Neo-Russellianism" (philosophy of language and logic).

Research Fields

Macroeconomics, Financial Economics, Monetary Economics, Firm Dynamics

References

Priit Jeenas
Assistant Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Jordi Galí
Senior Researcher
CREi

Jan Eeckhout
ICREA Research Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Dmitry Kuvshinov
Associate Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Job Market Paper

The Effects of Corporate Purchase Programmes on Market Power [Draft]

Does the corporate branch of unconventional monetary policy affect the market power of firms? I address this question both empirically and theoretically. Exploiting publicly available data on the European Central Bank's Corporate Sector Purchase Programme, I build security-level datasets that identify which bonds the Eurosystem actually bought and when. Firms whose bonds are purchased raise their markups by 7.1 percent. The transmission channel runs from issuing conditions to capital: purchased bonds are issued at a 22 basis point lower yield to maturity, and purchased firms invest 2.2 percentage points more. These effects materialise only under two conditions: purchases must be repeated over the years, and they must happen within a week of the bond issuance. A three-period general equilibrium model rationalises these findings, combining endogenous markups and financial frictions. Purchases reduce private intermediaries' holdings of a firm's debt, raise the price at which it is placed, relax the constraint on capital, and thus raise output, market share and markups. A quantitative version evaluates purchase designs that trade off relaxing financial constraints against raising market power.

Work in Progress

Synthetic Risk Transfers: Effects on Financial Fragility and Redistribution (with Gabriela Araujo)

Quantitative Easing in a Currency Union (with Antonio Giribaldi and Iginio Marchesini Reggiani)

Conferences and Seminars

2026 BSE PhD Jamboree; BSE Summer Forum (Financial Shocks, Channels and Macro Outcomes Workshop); International Ioannina Meeting on Applied Economics and Finance; SED Annual Meeting; EEA-ESEM Congress

2025 CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra); Catalan Economic Society Congress; PhD Meetings in Economics; Madrid Mountain Macro Conference (poster); Naples School of Economics Workshop; Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía

2024 CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra); Imperial College PhD Conference in Economics and Finance; BSE PhD Jamboree

2023 CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra)

Teaching Experience

Barcelona School of Economics – Graduate Courses

Teaching Assistant for:

"Advanced Macroeconomics III" (PhD track) — 2023, 2024, 2025
Professors: Jordi Galí and Priit Jeenas

Universitat Pompeu Fabra – Undergraduate Courses

Teaching Assistant for:

"Macroeconomics I" — 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Professors: Isaac Baley and Davide Debortoli

Research and Professional Experience

Research Assistant – Prof. Jan Eeckhout, Universitat Pompeu Fabra — 2026–2027

Research Assistant – Prof. Priit Jeenas, Barcelona School of Economics — Nov 2021–Jul 2023

Additional Coursework

2024 Difference-in-Differences and Event Study Estimators with Panel Data (by Jeffrey Wooldridge) – EABCN

Awards and Scholarships

GPEFM PhD Track Fellowship, Universitat Pompeu Fabra — 2021–2026
Dean Award for Achievement, The University of Manchester — 2020
Stellify Award, The University of Manchester — 2020
BA(Econ) Economics and other Social Sciences Second Year Prize, The University of Manchester — 2019
Czeslaw Lejewski Logic Second Year Prize, The University of Manchester — 2019
Gold Manchester Leadership Programme, The University of Manchester — 2019

Languages and Technical Skills

Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (proficient), Greek (basic), Catalan (basic)

Software and Programming: MATLAB (advanced), R (advanced), Stata (advanced), LaTeX (advanced), Julia (intermediate), Python (basic)